Balor Skallfang, The Tainted

Lore & Background:

Balor, Khar'Zul, The Crimson Covenant and the Skallfang Clan



“The sword is not your burden… Your burden is choosing how to wield it” -

Hrothgar Skallfang, Chieftain of the Skallfang Clan

The War Against Khar’Zul

Centuries before the birth of Balor, long before the kingdoms of the present age were founded, the world stood on the brink of annihilation. At the head of the demonic legions marched a name whispered only in forbidden texts:

Khar’Zul, The Flesh That Remembers…

One of the oldest Balor’s to ever emerge from the Abyss, Khar’Zul was far more than a conqueror. Entire civilizations fell beneath his advance; heroes were corrupted by his mere presence, and every apparent victory against him only reinforced a terrifying truth: Khar’Zul could never truly die…

Those who managed to destroy his physical form soon discovered that his body had never been the true threat. His essence endured beyond death itself. No spell could erase it, no divine miracle could extinguish it, and no prison created by mortal hands could contain it for long.

Faced with extinction, old enemies forged and unprecedented alliance. Kings, archmages, high priests, ancient monster hunters and knightly orders united in a final war against the Balor. Among them fought the ancestors of the **Skallfang Clan**, already renowned in those forgotten ages as fearless warriors who defended the frozen northern frontier against the horrors that wandered beyond civilization.

The war lasted for years. Kingdoms disappeared from history, mountains were reduced to ash and the skies themselves burned beneath the fury of the Abyss. At unimaginable cost, the alliance finally achieved the impossible.

Khar’Zul fell… yet victory revealed an even greater problem. His body had been destroyed but the demon himself had not, his essence lived on through the Abyss allowing him to build a new physical form.

The greatest scholars and priests of the age desperately searched for a vessel capable of containing an essence that refused to perish. Every enchanted relic shattered beneath its corruption. Every magical prison eventually failed. Every divine seal proved temporary. Only then did they realize a terrible truth. There already existed a vessel capable of bearing Khar’Zul’s immortal essence…

His own sword.

For countless millennia Khar’Zul carried that colossal blade through every battlefield. It had absorbed his blood, his victories, his hatred, and his corruption until it ceased to be

merely a weapon. It had become an extension of his very existence. No other artifact in creation possesed a bond so profound with the Balor, and no other object could survive the burden of containing him.

In a final act of desperation, the alliance turned Khar'Zul's own weapon against him.

Through the greatest sealing ritual ever performed, they bound the immortal essence of the Balor within the blade itself. Not inside a gemstone. Not within a magical prison. But inside the weapon that had served as his companion throughout countless wars.

It wasn't merely imprisonment. It was condemnation.

The greatest general of the Abyss became forever trapped within the very weapon he had once wielded.

Centuries passed, and the sword slowly began to change.

Steel gave way to living flesh. Veins spread beneath the metal. Muscles wrapped themselves around the guard, and eventually a single enormous eye opened within the blade, forever watching the world around it. As the years became centuries and centuries became legends, no one could any longer tell where the demon ended, and the sword began.

Khar'Zul no longer regarded the blade as his prison. It had become his body.

When the war finally ended, the alliance celebrated what they believed to be the end of the greatest threat the world had ever known. The sword would be hidden. The seal would endure. History would forget the name of Khar'Zul… But not everyone shared that belief.

Among those who had stood upon that battlefield were individuals who had witnessed something they could not ignore. They had seen the impossible. The ritual had not destroyed Khar'Zul. It had preserved him… To them, the prison was never a punishment, but a chrysalis.

They believed that, imprisoned within the blade, Khar'Zul was no longer merely waiting. He was changing. Evolving into something greater than any Balor had ever been. Refusing to accept the decision of the alliance, these dissidents disappeared into the shadows, carrying with them fragments of the sealing ritual, ancient records, forbidden knowledge and relics recovered from the battlefield.

Over the centuries they became known by another name…

The Crimson Covenant

But not all who survived the war chose that path.

The ancestors of the Skallfang Clan returned to the frozen north carrying a different burden. They neither sought to destroy the sword nor to study its power. Instead, they swore an oath that would be passed from one chieftain to the next for generations:

“So long as the blood of the Skallfang endures… Khar’Zul shall never walk the world again”

As the centuries passed, much of the knowledge surrounding the war faded into myth. History became legend, and legend became little more than stories told around the fire. Only scattered fragments of the truth survived, preserved within the traditions of the Skallfang Clan.

Many generations later, those forgotten fragments would eventually find their way into the hands of a single chieftain…

Hrothgar Skallfang



The Crimson Covenant

In the centuries that followed Khar'Zul's imprisonment, history slowly buried the truth beneath myth. Kingdoms rose and fell, empires crumbled, and the names of those who fought in the **Last Alliance** faded into obscurity. Yet not every witness allowed the memory of that day to disappear.

Among the victors were men and women who had stood before the sealed blade and reached a conclusion unlike any other…

They did not believe Khar'Zul had been defeated, they believed he had been transformed.

To them, the sealing ritual was not the end of the Balor's existence, but the beginning of something greater. While the rest of the world celebrated what they believed was a final victory, these dissidents became convinced that the blade had not merely imprisoned Khar'Zul's essence… It had preserved it, perfected it. The prison, they believed, was never intended as punishment; it was a chrysalis.

From that belief, The Crimson Covenant was born.

Its earliest members vanished from history, carrying fragments of the sealing ritual with them. Ancient manuscripts recovered from the battlefield and knowledge that the remaining heroes swore should never again see the light of day. Across generations they built their order in absolute secrecy, passing their teachings only to those deemed worthy of carrying their purpose forward.

Unlike the countless death cults and demon worshippers that have appeared throughout history, the Crimson Covenant doesn't just worship Khar'Zul. They believe they understand him.

According to their doctrine, Khar'Zul represents an inevitable truth about the world. Civilizations collapse, kings die, empires turn to dust and even the gods themselves are not eternal… Only Khar'Zul has endured every age.

To the Covenant, this is not proof of evil; it is proof of destiny. Their scriptures teach that no prison can contain Khar'Zul forever, and that the world faces only two possible futures… The first is chaos, a day when the seal inevitably fails and Khar'Zul returns to the world as the same unstoppable force that once nearly destroyed it. The second is ascension, a controlled rebirth.

A new existence in which Khar'Zul returns not as an uncontrollable demon of the Abyss, but as something greater… his immortal essence united with a mortal vessel capable of tempering his power.

For centuries, this belief guided every action the Covenant took. They didn't seek to break the seal but sought to prepare for the day it would no longer be enough. Thus began the greatest undertaking in the Covenant's history. A project that would span generations, a project known only as…

Genesis

Its purpose was simple in concept, yet impossible in execution:

To create a mortal capable of carrying the essence of Khar'Zul without being consumed by it. Using tiny fragments of living flesh taken from the sealed blade itself, the Covenant conducted countless rituals and experiments across the centuries. Every attempt ended in failure.

Humans perished within days, Elves lost their minds, Dwarves rejected the corruption entirely. Most subjects simply disintegrated beneath the unbearable weight of Khar'Zul's essence. Only one bloodline consistently survived longer than the others…

Tieflings

The Covenant spent generations searching for a lineage strong enough to survive the ritual completely. Entire family trees were recorded, manipulated and followed through the centuries as the order sought the one individual capable of becoming the perfect vessel. Eventually, they believed they had found her.

A young tiefling woman whose blood carried every trait the Covenant had spent centuries searching for. She became the final subject of Project Genesis. And from that ritual, the baby that would be known as Balor, was born.

The Covenant never saw him as an individual but as the culmination of centuries of sacrifice, research and unwavering faith, the vessel through which Khar'Zul would one day be reborn.

Everything changed the night his mother betrayed the Covenant. She fled with both the newborn child and the sealed blade, disappearing into the northern wilderness before the order could stop her. In a single night… centuries of planning vanished.

The Crimson Covenant has searched for them ever since for it is their undying belief that without Balor, the future they have dedicated their entire existence to can never come to pass.

To this day, few even know the Covenant exists.

Its agents walk unnoticed among kings, churches, guilds and scholars alike. Its members rarely reveal their faces, preferring masks, titles and symbols over names. Entire generations dedicate their lives to a purpose whose true origins have long since been forgotten by all but the highest ranks of the order.



The Skallfang Clan

Far beyond the borders of the northern kingdoms, where mountains meet endless forests and civilization slowly gives way to wilderness, lies the ancestral homeland of the Skallfang Clan.

For countless generations, the Skallfang have lived upon the northern frontier, a land where monsters vastly outnumber men and survival is earned through strength, discipline and unity. Their villages stand as the last bastions between the civilized world and the countless horrors that emerge from the frozen wilds beyond.

Unlike most barbarian tribes, the Skallfang do not seek conquest. They do not raid neighboring settlements for glory, nor do they measure strength through domination. To them, strength exists for one purpose alone...

To protect those who cannot protect themselves

Long before the kingdoms of the present age were founded, the ancestors of the Skallfang stood amongst the warriors of the Last Alliance that brought an end to

Khar'Zul's reign. Though much of that history has faded into myth, fragments of their ancient duty survived through countless generations.

The clan continued to guard the northern frontier, believing that no matter how peaceful the world became, darkness would always return.

Every child born into the clan is raised under the same oath:

"

When darkness comes… we stand.

When darkness grows… we hunt.

When darkness falls… we remain.

"

These are not merely words; they define every aspect of the Skallfang life. Children learn to hunt before they can read, and every warrior is expected to defend the weak before seeking personal glory.

No hunt is undertaken alone; no wounded warrior is abandoned. Cowardice is despised far more than death itself. Among the Skallfang, rage is not viewed as blind fury, it is discipline. The strength to continue fighting when the body begs to surrender, the resolve to stand between innocent lives and the monsters that threaten them. To lose control is considered a failure but to master one's rage is the mark of a true warrior.

This philosophy shaped generations of Skallfang hunters and eventually gave rise to some of the finest monster slayers the North had ever known. Although the clan preserved fragments of the ancient knowledge surrounding Khar'Zul, the truth slowly faded with time. Stories became legends; legends became tradition, and eventually only scattered records remained, passed from one chieftain to the next. Most members of the clan believed these tales to be little more than the embellished history of their ancestors.

Only the chieftains understood that buried somewhere within those old stories lay a truth worth preserving.

It was this forgotten legacy that eventually reached Hrothgar Skallfang, who would unknowingly become the guardian of both the sealed blade and the child destined to carry it.



Hrothgar Skallfang

Among the many chieftains who led the Skallfang Clan throughout its long history, few were as respected as Hrothgar Skallfang: a veteran of countless hunts, he embodied every virtue the clan sought to instill in its warriors. Though age had begun to slow his body, neither wisdom nor resolve had ever left him. To his people, he was far more than a chieftain. He was a protector, a teacher and the living embodiment of the Skallfang oath.

Like every Chieftain before him, Hrothgar inherited the fragmented records passed down through generations of clan leaders. Much of their history had already been lost to time, leaving behind only scattered journals, damaged scrolls and oral traditions describing an ancient war against a being called Khar'Zul. Most believed these accounts to be little more than legends rooted in truth. But Hrothgar did not.

Throughout his life he dedicated himself to preserving what remained of that forgotten history. Whenever traders, scholars or wandering adventurers passed through the northern frontier, he sought every scrap of information concerning ancient relics, lost civilizations, and demonic entities. Over decades he slowly pieced together fragments that previous generations had overlooked, becoming convinced that the stories carried by the Skallfang were more than simple myth.

But everything changed during a routine night hunt deep within the northern wilderness...

There, hidden inside the ruins of an ancient battlefield swallowed by snow and time, Hrothgar discovered an abandoned infant lying beside a demonic looking greatsword,

long tendrils of corruptions were consuming the blade, with a small slit close to the guard of the sword. A long trail of footprints and red tinted snow were found close to the scene…

Hrothgar's heart skipped a beat, as he recognized the blade from the oldest sketches preserved within the clan's forgotten records, Hrothgar immediately understood that this discovery was no coincidence.

He took both the child and the sword back to the Skallfang settlement… But no one could carry the sword, not even Hrothgar himself. It almost felt as if didn't want to be wielded… Or maybe it wanted to be wielded by the right person. Hrothgar approached the small babe to the sword and as the small touched it… The slit in the sword revealed a great yellow demonic eye. The sword slowly started to float and followed after the small baby.

The infant became known as Balor; the sword was hidden from the rest of the clan.

In the years that followed, Hrothgar secretly compared the blade to every fragment of knowledge he possessed. Although much had been lost to history, he became increasingly convinced that the weapon could only be Khar'Zul himself. Yet the surviving records were incomplete. They spoke of a sealing ritual, an immortal demon and an oath sworn by the ancestors of the Skallfang, but offered few answers as to why the child had been found beside the blade or what connection existed between them… except for one name, whose origin he also couldn't trace…

The Crimson Covenant.

Rather than burden Balor with fears he himself could not fully understand, Hrothgar chose silence. He raised the boy as one of his own, never treating him differently despite the suspicion that surrounded his origins. Under Hrothgar's guidance, Balor learned to hunt, to fight, to respect life and, above all else, to understand that true strength exists to protect others rather than dominate them.

As Balor grew older, Hrothgar continued his quiet investigation whenever opportunity allowed. Every recovered manuscript, every forgotten tale, and every relic that reached the northern frontier was carefully examined. Little by little he uncovered pieces of a far greater truth. Enough to understand that Balor's existence was no accident, but never enough to see the whole picture.

Life Among the Skallfang

Although no one knew where Balor had come from, the Skallfang never judged him by his blood. To them, a warrior was not defined by birth, but by the choices they made.

Raised beneath the watchful eye of Hrothgar, Balor grew up as any other child of the clan. He learned to survive the unforgiving northern wilderness before he ever understood the

world beyond it. Hunting, tracking, woodcraft and combat became part of his daily life, while the harsh climate forged both his body and his spirit.

From an early age, Balor displayed remarkable physical strength. Though younger than many of his peers, he could already wield weapons too heavy for most grown warriors. The elders often joked that the mountains themselves had carved him from stone.

Yet Hrothgar was careful never to let strength become arrogance; every lesson of combat was accompanied by a lesson in restraint. Every hunt was a reminder that courage existed to protect others, not to seek glory.

As the years passed, Balor earned the respect of the clan not because he was the strongest among them, but because he never hesitated to place himself between danger and those who couldn't defend themselves. Whether rescuing injured hunters, protecting younger children during training or facing creatures larger than himself, he acted without expecting recognition. Among the Skallfang such actors spoke louder than any victory.

The clan had accepted him as one of their own, and he grew to love them as family. The elders became his teachers, the hunters his brothers and sisters and Hrothgar the only father he had ever known.

Like every warrior born into the clan, Balor eventually came of age and faced the **Trial of the Fang**, the ancient rite of passage that every Skallfang must complete before being recognized as a true warrior. Alone, each initiate is sent into the frozen wilderness to overcome a challenge worthy of remembrance. Some return after slaying a great beast. Others survive impossible odds or rescue those thought lost. The deed itself is never what matters most. It is the strength og character revealed through it.

Upon returning to the village, the Chieftain gathers the entire clan and bestows upon the warrior a Skallfang byname. A title earned through deed rather than birth. That name becomes part of the warrior's identity for the rest of their life, carrying both honor and legacy.

Balor's trial would become one of the most remembered in the history of the clan. While protecting members of his hunting party from a monstrous creature of the frozen wilds, Balor was pushed to the very limits of his body. Cornered, wounded and with the lives of his companions depending upon him, he embraced the Rage that every Skallfang warrior learns to master.

But what emerged was unlike anything the clan had ever witnessed…

As his Rage reached his peak, the dormant power hidden within his blood answered. His already imposing horns grew longer and darker, twisting like obsidian. His eyes ignited with the glow of molten lava. Crimson veins spread beneath his ashen skin as

though fire itself flowed through his body and his claws lengthened into wicked talons, while his tail grew larger and more powerful.

For a brief moment, those who stood beside him witnessed not only the warrior they had raised but the infernal heritage that had always slept within him.

Yet despite the terrifying transformation, Balor never lost himself. His fury remained disciplined, and his mind remained clear. His strength was directed only against the creature that threatened his people.

After returning to the clan village, Hrothgar was informed of what happened. Overjoyed with pride he met with Balor and declared before the entire clan:

“He bears a darkness not of his choosing, yet it is not the darkness that defines the man… but the man who master's the darkness.”

That day, Hrothgar bestowed upon him the byname that would follow him throughout his life…

Balor, The Tainted.

But one mystery remained from Balor’s childhood… **The Sword.** He often found himself drawn to it, unable to explain why its silent presence felt so familiar. Whenever he asked about it, Hrothgar simply answered that some burdens revealed their purpose only when the time was right.

Though Balor Accepted those words, he could never completely ignore the strange feeling that the blade was somehow aware of him.

He would also start to have a reoccurring dream. An ashen field, a red sky, a winged figure…

Also at times, while passing by Hrothgar’s lodge or standing alone in the silence of the northern night, he thought he heard faint whispers, carried by the wind…

“Vhar…”

“Kha…”

“Ashkar…”

“Mortal…”

And slowly, but surely, he started to understand them…

The Awakening

For many years, peace endured in the frozen lands of the Skallfang. The hunts continued, the children grew into warriors; the fires burned brightly within the village long after the sun had disappeared beneath the northern horizon. For Balor, life had become predictable as he believed it always would…

Until the night everything changed.

Without warning, a monstrous fiend had emerged from the darkness. Unlike the beasts the Skallfang hunted for generations, this creature displayed a terrifying intelligence. It did not attack wildly. It hunted with purpose, cutting through the village as though searching for something…

The warriors of the clan answered immediately; among them stood Hrothgar. Though age had long begun to weigh upon his body, the old Chieftain fought with the same determination that had made him a legend among his people. Spear in hand, he rallied the Skallfang and confronted the creature while ordering the younger warriors to protect the villagers. Balor fought with his brothers and sisters.

But the creature ignored every opportunity to slaughter indiscriminately, and instead it continued advancing toward Hrothgar's lodge…

Toward the sword within.

As the battle reached its climax, the fiend broke through the Skallfang lines and struck Hrothgar down. Gravely wounded, the old Chieftain struggled to rise once more, buying precious moments for those around him to escape.

For the first time in his life, Balor saw his father fall. Overwhelmed with emotion and ignoring every warning Hrothgar had ever given him, Balor rushed into the burning lodge and reached for the enormous blade. The closer he got to it, he could feel its influence, its calling, its voice… and right before Balor touched the great blade, Hrothgar entered the lodge, supporting his dead weight on his spear. He fell and at that moment Balor rushed to his aid:

"Balor… if you draw that blade… nothing will ever be the same…"

Balor answers:

"I don't know what else to do…"

Hrothgar smiled, proud of his son and the man he had become, and with his last breath says:

"Then do what you believe is right. Not because you are afraid… but because you choose to stand"

Hrothgar's body slowly goes limp and Balor sees life slipping from his father's eyes... Overwhelmed with emotion, stands and rushes to grab the sword and in the moment he holds it...

The world disappears...

Balor stands in an ashen field under a bright red sky and before him stands a colossal figure. A Balor whose wings scorched the horizon, in one of his hands he held the sword Balor just held for the first time and in the other a whip of fire. A long silence ensued, until the the creature finally spoke...

"At last, ...

You do not wield me...

You carry me."

Then Balor wakes up...

Back to the world he knows, laying on the floor beside the monstrous sword. He slowly sat up and before him was the mangled, twisted body of the creature who terrorized his people. Hope sparkled in his eyes... until he witnessed the consequence of his actions.

The whole village was ravaged... Mutilated bodies, viscera, blood and demonic corruption decorated the battlefield...

The Last Gift of Hrothgar

In the days that followed the attack, an unnatural silence settled over the Skallfang village. The fires had long since faded, replaced by the smoke of funeral pyres rising into the northern sky...

Balor stood against them in silence. He had survived but many better warriors had not, a guilt he could carry with him for the rest of his life. The weight of Khar'Zul rested across his back, heavier now than it had ever felt...

When the mourning came to an end, Balor returned alone to Hrothgar's lodge. The building suffered greatly during the battle. Shelves had collapsed; furniture lay splintered across the floor, and countless scrolls had been reduced to ash. Decades of Hrothgar's research had all but vanished in a single night.

For hours, Balor searched through the ruins; most of what was found was unreadable. Burned pages, broken seals, maps consumed by fire, records whose meaning had been lost forever.

Yet buried beneath the collapsed remains of Hrothgar's desk, he discovered a small leather satchel that had somehow survived the destruction. Inside was a weathered

journal containing fragmented notes from Hrothgar's investigation. Several damaged sketches depicting the sealed blade, references to an ancient demon named Khar'Zul, a crude map marking forgotten ruins scattered across the world and a strange crimson medallion engraved with a symbol Balor had never seen before. No explanation accompanied it; only a single name appeared several times throughout Hrothgar's surviving note...

The Crimson Covenant.

Tucked inside the final pages of the journal, Balor found one last handwritten note addressed to no one in particular, as though Hrothgar himself expected that one day another would continue his work:

"

If these pages have found their way into your hands, then my search has come to an end. I have encountered fragments but never the whole truth. Trust the

> lessons I taught you more than the answers you seek. A blade does not choose the hand that first lifts it, but every hand chooses what it becomes thereafter. If fate has placed this burden upon your shoulders, carry it as a Skallfang.

"

For a long time, he remained alone within the ruined lodge. The questions far outnumbered the answers. Yet for the first time in his life, he had a direction. Somewhere beyond the world he knew lay the truth behind Khar'Zul, The Crimson Covenant and his own birth.

When dawn finally broke over the mountains, Balor knew what he had to do...

The Exile

The morning after Hrothgar's funeral, the Skallfang village awoke beneath a silent blanket of snow. For the first time in his life, Balor no longer felt at home...

Every path through the settlement carried memories of those who had fallen. Every familiar face reminded him of the price the clan had paid. Though no one blamed him for the tragedy, Balor could not silence the thought that had haunted him since the battle. The creature had not come by chance; it had come to search...

And wherever Khar'Zul went, others would inevitably follow. To remain among the Skallfang was to place the only family he had ever known in constant danger. That burden was his alone to carry.

Before sunrise, Balor returned one final time to Hrothgar's grave. There he laid his hand upon the weathered stone marker and remained silent for several moments...

At last, he spoke.

"

> You gave me a name, a family, and a purpose.
>
> Father, I swear upon the blood of the Skallfang that I will find the truth you sought.
>
> And I will ensure that Khar'Zul never threatens this world again.

"

With those words, Balor rose. He fastened the surviving fragments of Hrothgar's journal securely within his pack. He slung Khar'Zul across his back, wrapping the living blade once more beneath layers of worn cloth so that only its steel edge remained visible to the outside world. Around his waist rested the broad warrior's belt bearing the sigil of the Skallfang Clan. From either side hung the twin handaxes that had accompanied him throughout his years as a hunter. Everything he carried reminded him of the people he had sworn to protect.

Before leaving the village, Balor turned for one final look. The smoke rising from the longhouses, the snow-covered training grounds, the great hall where he had grown from child to warrior. The graves of those who had raised him...

He knew he might never see them again.

Without another word, Balor crossed the northern pass and disappeared into the wilderness beyond. From that day forward, he would roam the world not only as a Skallfang hunter but as...

The unwilling bearer of Khar'Zul.

The final thread connecting a forgotten war, a hidden order and a destiny older than kingdoms themselves. His journey was no longer one of survival; it had become a search. A search for the truth behind his birth, for the purpose of the Crimson Covenant.

And the answers buried alongside the name that now whispered endlessly from the blade upon his back.

Khar'Zul.

Extra: Appendix

The Rite of Ash

Whenever the whispers become unbearable, the blade grows restless or is stained with the blood of Balor's victims; Balor performs the Rite of Ash.

Planting Khar'Zul into the earth, he rests his forehead against the hilt and recites an ancient prayer preserved within Hrothgar's surviving notes.

The words are spoken in old Abyssal dialect whose true origins remain unknown. Balor believes the ritual calms the demon. Whether it truly restrains Khar'Zul or merely strengthens Balor's resolve remains uncertain.

The Prayer:

"

Sleep, Khar'Zul

Your prison remains

I carry your burden, but not your chains

Rest… until I call upon your strength

"

Abyssal:

"

Varesh, Khar'Zul

Thar vek narak

Vor ash thar… nar vor kel

Varesh… tek vor kel

Features:

+1 to Attack Rolls

+1 to Damage Rolls

Weapon Damage becomes 2d8 Slashing

Sentience begins to awaken

Balor hears faint whispers

Drawback:

Whenever Khar'Zul remains for several days or drinks large amounts of blood in battle, the whispers intensify until Balor performs the Rite of Ash.

Level 2 – The Smoldering Heart

Features:

Weapon becomes Magical

Addtional 1d4 Fire Damage

Advantage on Intimidation, Insight and Religion checks.

Advantage to identify Demonic Magic, Infernal Rituals and Abyssal Curses.

Ability: Infernal Vitality – When Balor kills an enemy he gets 1d6 + PB HP. One time per Short Rest.

Drawback:

The scent of fresh blood is becoming increasingly intoxicating.

The DM may occasionally ask for a Wisdom Saving Throw to resist Khar'Zul's influence after particularly brutal battles.

Level 3 – The Burning Will

Features:

Additional Fire Damage increases to 1d6

Can't be surprised while wielding Khar'Zul

+2 bonus to Strength checks

Whenever hit with Fire Damage, get Temp HP equal to PB.

Ability: Infernal Charge – Balor charges Khar'Zul with Abyssal flame before slamming it into the ground. Creatures in a radius determined during balancing suffer weapon damage plus fire damage and must make a Dex ST or be knocked prone.

Drawback:

Each use causes the whispers to become significantly stronger until the Rite of Ash is performed.

Level 4 – Flesh and Steel

Features:

Additional Fire Damage becomes 1d8.

Advantage on all Saving Throws against being Charmed or Frightened.

Ability: Hellbreaker – Balor plants Khar'Zul into the ground releasing a wave of infernal fire in a cone of radius to be determined.

Drawback:

Whenever Balor falls below a chosen HP threshold, Khar'Zul may attempt to tempt him with greater power. Resisting requires a Wisdom Saving Throw, with consequences determined by DM.

Level 5 – The Flesh That Remembers

Khar'Zul unleashes a fraction of the power it once wielded during the ancient war. Rather than possessing Balor, the blade cloaks him in its own infernal essence. A colossal aura of crimson flame erupts around him.

Balor's Rage and Khar'Zul's power resonate as one.

Ultimate Feature

Avatar of the Living Prison

For a duration to be determined:

Increased melee damage

Additional Fire Damage on every strike.

Improved movement speed

Infernal abilities become empowered



Crimson Covenant Hierarchy

The Inner Circle – 7 members. The true leaders of the Covenant. The only ones who know the truth about Khar'Zul, Project Genesis, Balor, and the ritual.

The Apostles – 12 members. Execute the will of the Inner Circle. Each Apostle has a permanent mission like recovering artifacts, eliminating witnesses, infiltrating kingdoms or hunting Balor. They are extremely powerful.

The Cardinals - Each Cardinal controls a great region of the world. They recruit new members, finance operations, build hideouts and distribute artifacts. Don't know about the existence of the Inner Circle.

The Inquisitors – Elite agents. Assassins, Hunters and Detectives.

The Seekers – Archeologists, Mages and Historians. Specialists in ruins, ancient tongues, magic seals and demons.

The Apostles – Common cult members. Guards, Cultists and Mercenaries.

THE CRIMSON COVENANT

HIERARCHY OF THE COVENANT

I. THE INNER CIRCLE

7 MEMBERS

The true leaders. They know the entire truth.



THE EXARCH
Supreme leader and voice of the Covenant. Strategist. Diplomat. Unifier of the Circle.

THE FIRST WITNESS
Guardian of the true history. Remembers what must never be forgotten.

THE FLESHWRIGHT
Overseer of Project Genesis. Master of flesh, blood and transformation.

THE VEILED VOICE
Weaver of lies and truths. Master of espionage, manipulation and influence.

THE ASHEN JUDGE
Judge, executioner and keeper of the Covenant's laws and punishments.

THE KEEPER OF CHAINS
Warden of Khar'Zul. Guardian of the seals, rituals and bindings.

THE CRIMSON HAND
Commander of armies, operations and enforcement. The Covenant's blade.

They rule in silence. They are never seen together.

Their will is the Covenant.

II. THE APOSTLES

12 MEMBERS

Executors of the Inner Circle's will.



They carry out the greatest missions.

Each Apostle serves a purpose. Failure is not an option.

III. THE CARDINALS

Regional leaders. They control, resources, recruits and operations.



They believe they are the highest authority. They do not know of the Inner Circle.

IV. INQUISITORS

Elite agents. Assassins. Hunters. Investigators.



They are sent when a mission cannot fail. They leave no witnesses.

V. SEEKERS

Scholars. Archaeologists. Researchers. Linguists.



They uncover the secrets the Covenant has long forgotten.

VI. ACOLYTES

The many. Cultists. Guards. Fanatics.



They serve. They obey. They die for the mission.

THE COVENANT IS NOT BUILT ON LOYALTY. IT IS BUILT ON PURPOSE. MEN ARE TEMPORARY. THE MISSION IS ETERNAL.